Davenport. The coach went over the script with me and told me to report for work the next day.

When I woke up the following morning, I wanted to get out of town as quickly as I could. I thought about getting in my car and driving nonstop to Iowa.

Nothing I'd ever experienced—no stage fright before a college show or steeplechase jump or dive from a high platform, nothing I'd been through, had ever produced in me the kind of jitters I felt when I stepped onto Stage Eight at Warner Brothers that morning.

"Kid, don't worry," a veteran character actor who was in my first scene said. "Just take it easy and everything will be all right."

They sponged some makeup on my face, I took my place on the set, the lights went on, and the director, Nick Grinde, said: "Camera . . . Action!"

Suddenly, my jitters were gone. The old character actor had been right. As soon as I heard the director's words, I forgot all about the camera and the lights and the crew and concentrated on delivering my lines in a way that I hoped would make B. J. Frazer proud.

A couple of minutes later, the director said "Cut." To my amazement, he said he was satisfied with the first take. He started setting up to shoot the next scene and I sat down on one of those canvas chairs you see on movie sets (without my name on it) and said silently to myself: *You know, maybe I can make it here*.

Although we finished *Love Is on the Air* in three weeks, it wouldn't be released for four months so I had a long time to worry about whether Warner Brothers was going to renew my option. But they kept me busy. A few days after finishing this picture, I drew an assignment to play a cavalryman (more typecasting) in a picture based on a true story about a wonder horse named Sergeant Murphy that won Britain's Grand National steeplechase race. The *Des Moines Register*